



Facebook gets more transparent

Facebook's transparency report now includes action taken against graphic violence, adult nudity and more. <https://dgit.in/jun18-B38-1>

FAKE

583 Mil Facebook fakes

That's how many fake Facebook profiles were closed by Facebook in the first three months of 2018. <https://dgit.in/jun18-B38-2>

Rise of a technosexual dating era

Facebook recently delved into Tinder's sphere and launched an all-new dating feature that has brought the debate of technosexuality and its implications into the limelight.

Dhriti Datta | feedback@dgit.in



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technosexuality refers to individuals expressing their sexuality through technological means

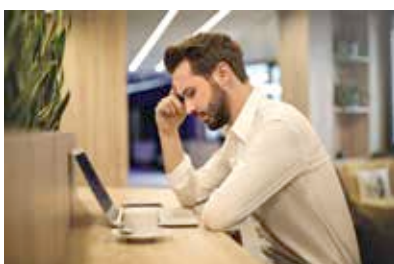
and media. Technosexuality also branches into the inexplicable love an individual feels towards technology, often preferring technologically-aided relationships or relationships with the technology itself. The Tinders, Plenty of Fish, Happns, and now, Facebooks of the world assist the unprecedented rise of a technosexual era which enables users to connect in a sexual and highly superficial way. Swiping right, liking, following, and other such gestures have transcended into becoming the new flirty smile across the bar, slipping your number to that girl you like or anxiously waiting for a call. Instant gratification is the highest valued commodity and these apps excel at this very feature. The technosexual era may be liberating in some aspects, but it brings a plethora of negative implications for society. We explore these very implications in this article.

MENTAL AND PHYSICAL HEALTH

The technosexual era has created an unattainable image of the perfect individual that users keep swiping left in search of. A study was conducted by the American Psychological Association in 2016 that indicated individuals that participate in online dating have a lower self-esteem and are more likely to be not sufficiently satiated with their own looks. Researchers at Brigham Young University found certain characteristics that indicate de-

pression amongst people who depend overtly on technology for meaningful relationships. On top of maintaining social and physical appearances IRL, the pressure of having the 'perfect' display picture and bio description can send individuals into a frenzy.

Physical health is also being constantly threatened and compromised in the technosexual era. The British Association for Sexual Health and HIV has uncovered an increase in the occurrences of sexually transmitted diseases after the release of apps like Tinder and Grindr. A study by Kesley in 2015 reveals evidence that signifies a 33% increase in gonorrhea and 19% elevation in syphilis. The health issues are of massive concern to the age group of 15-24 which, not coincidentally, is the biggest demographic on dating sites propagating the hookup culture. This age group represents 81% of the reported chlamydia cases according to the Department of Health in 2014.



The constant social pressure is amplified by the technosexual era's dating apps that need individuals to maintain a perfect front.